Kevan Maxwell Davis

Staff AI Product Engineer | Multimodal AI, Agent Systems & Product Architecture

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff AI Product Engineer focused on multimodal AI products and agent systems. Combines deep TypeScript/React expertise with model integration, agent orchestration, iterative evaluation, and technical leadership to take exploratory ideas through architecture, implementation, and adoption. Mentors engineers while remaining hands-on.

CORE SKILLS

AI product engineering: Vercel AI SDK, OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, multimodal generation, model routing and fallbacks, agent orchestration, AI evaluation, human-in-the-loop workflows, MCP, Pi extensions

Software and product: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Node.js, frontend architecture, reusable SDKs, API design, rapid prototyping, developer experience, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Prisma, Docker, Kubernetes

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shopify | Staff Software Engineer | 2021–November 2026

- Re-architected **Shopp-E**, an internal multimodal creation product, into an isomorphic TypeScript library built on **Vercel AI SDK**, consumed by web, CLI, and MCP interfaces for employee and AI-agent workflows. It generated **100,000+ images**, with daily generation frequently exceeding 1,000 and sometimes 2,000.
- Designed a capability-aware model registry tracking provider limits and costs, plus asynchronous jobs, outage fallbacks, and remote polling for long-running video generation; enabled expansion from images to video, speech, and music.
- Prototyped an AI agent to update heavily customized merchant email templates, reaching about **90% success** on a small curated benchmark comprising five representative template types drawn from 17 templates and five merchant configurations. Afterward, served as tech lead for a six-engineer production effort that was canceled before launch; neither effort launched or migrated customers.
- Built a working multi-agent code review system with lightweight classification and routing, specialist reviews for security, accessibility, APIs, and developer experience, aggregated findings, guided tours, and diagrams; piloted with a handful of colleagues.
- Developed Pi agent tooling for low-latency multi-model safety judgments with human override, web-to-Markdown retrieval, rich editor experiences, and extensible UI surfaces for Pi IDE.
- Extended UI extensions to Shopify's Admin product detail page, implementing the first Bundles extension card. Contributed to checkout and first-party bundle workflows; mentored junior engineers and an intern.
- Developed product-data coverage calculations and rule-inheritance visualizations for multichannel mapping rules, part of a merchant-facing product shipped in Shopify Editions in 2026.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Shopify | Senior Software Engineer | May 2019–2021

- Co-designed and prototyped the developer API for sandboxed **Checkout UI Extensions**, pairing a React-based extension model with remote UI; key architectural concepts continued into the production platform.
- Helped evolve Shopify's B2B commerce capabilities after the Handshake acquisition, including business customers and payment terms.
- Contributed to first-party post-checkout upsell capabilities; named co-inventor on U.S. Patent 11,403,658 (granted 2022).

Handshake (acquired by Shopify) | Senior Developer / Engineer | October 2014–May 2019

- Modernized a multi-tenant B2B commerce product as part of a small frontend team, contributing to a React migration, self-service wholesale ordering, and customizable catalogs.

Gilt Groupe | Web Developer → Senior Web Developer | April 2009–August 2014

- Built foundational frontend libraries, asset management and build tooling, cart interfaces, and two generations of checkout; supported responsive design and mentored engineers.

Earlier: Web Developer, Mindspark (2008–2009); Developer, Tyler Technologies (2006–2008); Research Assistant, University of Texas at Arlington AI Lab (through 2006).

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington | B.S., Computer Science